

9. CampusCareer: University Internship and Placement Hub

Background

A private university (CSE, BBA, EEE; ~1,200 graduates a year) with four career-services staff and 200+ employer relationships. Students apply for internships through scattered forms and email threads. Employers receive unscreened piles of CVs and quietly stop posting. Career staff cannot measure which departments or employers actually lead to placements, and the accreditation placement report takes three weeks of phone calls to assemble.

The problem today

- No single application record: staff forward CVs by email; status lives in inboxes.
- Employers cannot see which applicants are screened; students apply blind and hear nothing.
- Placement statistics are reconstructed manually, late, and partially.

Cost of failure

- Employers churning after one disorganized season = fewer internships for everyone.
- Students applying blind = low conversion and visible frustration.
- Staff drowning in CV forwarding have zero time for actual coaching.
- Unmeasurable placement performance is an accreditation and ranking risk.

Who is involved

Person	Their world	What frustrates them
Student (e.g., Tanvir, CSE '26)	Wants an internship; one CV, many doors	Applies into silence; no idea where he stands
Employer (e.g., Brain Station 23 HR)	Posts 3 slots, gets 300 CVs	Unscreened piles; no structured outcomes loop
Career staff (4 people)	The middle of everything	Manual matching, email archaeology
Department / university	Accreditation, rankings	Placement stats assembled by phone calls

What the product must do

1. Let employers post opportunities with real requirements (skills, departments, stipend, slots, deadline).
2. Let students apply once with a profile, and **track their own application journey**, every stage change visible to them.
3. Support staff screening with structured shortlists and kind, timely rejections.
4. Make employers update outcomes (interviewed / offered / hired), and make silence visible: an employer who hasn't reported outcomes for two weeks should be flagged for staff follow-up.
5. Produce the placement picture continuously: placements by department and employer, funnel conversion, median days-to-first-interview, no phone-call census.
6. Treat student data fairly: employers see profiles in the context of applications, not a browsable database.

Platform capabilities this case will exercise

A strong solution to this case will naturally need to draw on the full range of platform capabilities available — not just one or two. Concretely:

- Separate sign-in and permissions for students, employers, career staff, and the department, so an employer only ever sees applicants to its own postings.
- A single application record per student that tracks every stage change, visible to the student in real time.
- Structured shortlisting support for staff, with a recorded, kind rejection reason for candidates not moving forward.
- Employer-reported outcomes (interviewed / offered / hired) with automatic flags when an employer goes quiet for too long.
- Continuously computed placement analytics — by department and employer, funnel conversion, time-to-first-interview — with no manual census.
- Student-visible AI match explanations, so a student can see and flag what was said about their fit.

Access rules the business expects

- An employer sees only applicants to their own postings.
- A student sees their own applications and journey, never other applicants.
- If AI explanations of fit are produced, the student should be able to see what was said about them ,transparency over black boxes.

Where AI should help

Compare a student profile with an opportunity and explain the match **in plain language**: which required skills are covered, what's missing, what project or experience is most relevant, and one concrete coaching tip ("be ready to discuss automated testing in the interview"). Staff read it before shortlisting; a student can flag an explanation that seems wrong. Words, not a mysterious numeric score ,the explanation must be arguable with.

AI enhancement challenge

The base case asks the AI to explain one student-opportunity match in plain language. Push it further: have the AI scan all of a student's applications and proactively generate a short coaching digest for staff — which students are stuck in silence and why, with a suggested next action — rather than requiring staff to notice each stalled case on their own.

Realistic demo case to script

Brain Station 23 posts a 3-slot React internship. Three students apply; each gets a plain-language match explanation; staff shortlist two and send a kind rejection with a reason to the third. The student view shows the journey timeline. Complication: the employer goes quiet after interviews ,the overdue-outcome flag appears, staff escalate, the employer marks "hired," and the live placement dashboard updates. Close on the department/employer analytics the accreditation report used to take three weeks to build.

What "great" looks like

Career services answers in one screen: "Which employers convert, which departments place, and which students are stuck in silence right now?"
